AuthorsLab

Every author deserves an editorial team.

authorslab.ai · Pre-seed: **£350,000** (SEIS £250k + EIS £100k) · 18-month runway · August 2026

What we do

AuthorsLab is a subscription platform of **named AI editors** that carries a manuscript from upload to polished, publishable book. At launch, three editors — Alex (developmental), Sam (line), Jordan (copy) — run full-manuscript editorial passes; the author works chapter by chapter and downloads the finished result, with a dashboard holding every project. Professional human editing costs **$2,000–$10,000+ per book**; AuthorsLab's flagship plan is **£13/month**. Nothing else on the market sells this unit of value: a complete, multi-editor pass over an entire manuscript.

Why now, and why us

The writer market is bimodal — a UK professional author's median income is £7,000 and falling, while committed indies out-earn traditionally published peers and already spend $34/month replicating a fraction of our scope across three partial tools (Sudowrite + Scrivener + ProWritingAid). We price the commitment, not the average: capacity-based tiers with no feature gating. And we launch instrumented — **every AI call on the platform writes tokens and cost to a live ledger**, so our COGS are measured per author, per manuscript, per feature from day zero. Unit economics as instrument readings, not projections — the thing seed investors ask for, running before the seed round.

Traction (production database, 5 August 2026)

11 beta authors	272 chapters	4,061 messages	789 findings	Live billing
grandfathered as Founding Authors at £9.50/mo for life	under active editing across 8 manuscripts	of editor–author collaboration in the live database	editorial issues tracked by the AI team	Stripe catalogue live: 3 tiers × monthly/annual + one-time pass

Public launch of the editing studio: this week. Free full-manuscript assessment (no card) opens the funnel; paid channel tests begin this month with per-channel CAC measured from the first ad.

Business model

Three writer tiers keyed to **capacity** (full-manuscript editorial passes per month), not features: Starter £7/mo · Author £13/mo · Pro £27/mo billed annually (£10/£19/£39 monthly), plus a £119 one-time single-project pass that credits toward membership. A separate **imprint SKU (£250–£1,000/mo)** opens the B2B axis — small UK imprints demonstrably pay £600/mo for editorial SaaS today, and our September demo is to the Executive Publisher of a new London imprint backed by The Blair Partnership, with a 20–50 author list.

The platform then grows as **a series of finished products**, each releasing into the existing tiers: Wright (drafting collaborator), Design (covers), Publishing Hub, Marketing Hub, and Riley (a companion who remembers the author's whole journey). Each release is a marketing beat and a pricing event — **new-customer prices step up while existing subscribers keep their price for life**. Early believers are locked in; the price rises with the platform.

Financial model (36 months, every line tagged by evidence class)

On deliberately conservative funnel assumptions the model reaches **~£32k MRR and ~1,570 paying writers at month 36**, with month-12 unit economics of **3.3× LTV:CAC** and 55–65% editing-phase gross margin. COGS lines are instrument-backed: first ledger readings put a full developmental pass at roughly half our planning figure, before prompt caching (a further ~90% reduction on repeated context). Funnel and churn lines are labelled as assumptions until launch data lands — which starts this month. The full model (GBP, monthly, 36 months) is available in the data room.

The ask — £350,000 pre-seed for 18 months of proof

Use of funds	£k	The 18 months buys
Team & operations	**162**	Public launch scaled: proven acquisition channels with measured CAC
Marketing ramp (£2.5k→£8k/mo)	**111**	Full product line shipped: four launch beats, four price steps
Product development (staged releases)	**72**	First imprint contract live (September conversation booked)
Contingency (~20%)	**61**	Ledger-calibrated pricing holding ≥70% flagship gross margin
Total plan (£350k raise + £56k modelled gross profit)	**406**	Seed-ready: repeatable channels, LTV/CAC evidence, B2B revenue axis

Structure: £250k under SEIS (50% investor income-tax relief; advance assurance in progress) + £100k EIS. At 12–15% dilution this implies £2.3–2.9m post-money, in line with UK pre-seed norms. Bootstrapped to launch under Spike Island Studios.

Team

Paul Lyons, Founder — [bio placeholder: background, contract-management & AI systems leadership; built AuthorsLab and CLARENCE under Spike Island Studios]. **Carl [surname]**, Co-founder, Commercial & Strategy — [bio placeholder].

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